

Respiratory Health and Diseases

RESPIRATORY HEALTH AND DISEASES

Understanding the Respiratory System:

The respiratory system includes the nose, trachea, lungs, and diaphragm. It's responsible for gas exchange and breathing.

Common Respiratory Conditions:

Asthma: Chronic inflammatory disease of airways, symptoms include wheezing and shortness of breath, triggered by allergens and exercise

COPD: Progressive disease affecting breathing, includes emphysema and chronic bronchitis, usually caused by smoking

Pneumonia: Infection causing inflammation in lungs, can be bacterial, viral, or fungal

Bronchitis: Inflammation of airways in lungs, acute or chronic, causes persistent cough

Lung Cancer: Leading cancer death in smokers and non-smokers, risk factors include smoking and secondhand smoke

Risk Factors:

- Smoking and secondhand smoke
- Air pollution
- Occupational exposure (dust, chemicals)
- Infections
- Genetics
- Age
- Indoor air quality

Prevention:

- Don't smoke (or quit)
- Avoid secondhand smoke
- Reduce air pollution exposure
- Get vaccinated (flu, pneumonia)
- Maintain clean home environment
- Use air purifiers
- Regular exercise
- Healthy diet

Symptoms Requiring Medical Attention:

- Persistent cough lasting 3+ weeks
- Coughing up blood
- Shortness of breath at rest
- Chest pain
- Fever